with Trichy's plans. With Vicky, Raghu, Guna and Dixon gone, Trichy would have to look for the right replacement. Till then, he might be visiting hideouts to check on the wounded. Vicky revealed the frequency of the station that was used to communicate from Trichy's UHF wireless set. But neither the intelligence agencies nor the SIT could intercept any messages. It could be that there was no one to operate it, Guna felt.

Ragothaman's moles in the LTTE endorsed Vicky's prediction of Sivarasan making his own arrangements for escaping. Some reports suggested that he had asked for more AK-47 rifles and ammunition. Obviously, those were unconfirmed reports. Kaarthikeyan knew the only way to One-Eyed Jack was through Trichy. The only lead Vicky could give them was a sketchy description of a hideout in Thippasandra in Bangalore. He had an idea about the area. Ragothaman thought the boy's memory would not be failing him since he had visited the said house with cash for Trichy two weeks before his arrest. Vicky gave two more pieces of information—that Trichy used a blue AC Premier Padmini car and the political groups had a green Maruti Gypsy.

On 31 July, Kaarthikeyan sent out two teams—one to Trichy to check the Mutharasanallur hideout and another to Bangalore, where Trichy Santhan could be cooling his heels if Vicky's admission was correct. As suspected, there was no sign of the wanted in the hideout in Trichy. However, it was loaded with medicines, empty grenade shells, grenades, splinters used in hand grenades and bombs, ammunition, explosives and two UHF wireless sets, all concealed in wooden boxes purported to be a shipment of fruits. A homoeopathy doctor owned the place. On questioning him, he denied any knowledge of what his tenants did. However, such replies had become standard from landlords if and when their tenants were caught indulging in unlawful activities or linked with the Tamil Tigers. He was taken to the police station for interrogation.